

X-39MATRIX · OpenSats Reference Letter Template

Fill-in-the-blank format for referees

Purpose: This template lets your referee write a strong OpenSats reference letter in ~5 minutes instead of 1 hour. Just fill 4 placeholders, sign PGP, send back.

To the referee: Below is a complete letter. You only need to: 1. Replace the 4 placeholders marked [BRACKETS] . 2. Sign it with your PGP key (instructions at the bottom). 3. Send the signed .asc back to grants@x39matrix.org .

That's it. No layout, no formatting, no stress.

THE LETTER (copy from here to "END OF LETTER")

To: OpenSats Board of Directors
From: [YOUR_FULL_NAME]
Date: 2026-__-__ (today)
Re: Reference letter for Jose Luis Olivares Esteban – X-39MATRIX

Dear OpenSats Board,

I am writing in support of Jose Luis Olivares Esteban's application to the OpenSats General Fund for the X-39MATRIX Layer 10 project.

[RELATIONSHIP – 1-2 sentences: how you know Jose Luis. Examples:

"I have known Jose Luis since 2024 through the OpenTimestamps community, where he has consistently operated a public OTS calendar with high reliability."

– OR –

"I reviewed the X-39MATRIX cryptographic stack in early 2026 and have followed its public anchoring activity on Bitcoin mainnet ever since."

– OR –

"We collaborated on the [PROJECT/MAILING_LIST/FORUM] where Jose Luis demonstrated rigorous technical discipline."]

[TECHNICAL OPINION – 1-2 sentences: your view on the project's technical merit. Examples:

"X-39MATRIX is one of the few public projects today that combines threshold-ECDSA on ICP with multiple NIST-finalized post-quantum signatures (ML-DSA-87 + SLH-DSA-256s) and anchors every artifact in Bitcoin mainnet via OpenTimestamps. The technical execution is rigorous and the public verifier script is auditable."

– OR –

"The proposed Layer 10 zk-STARK migration from SHA-256 to Rescue-Prime AIR is a meaningful contribution to the post-quantum Bitcoin anchoring stack and aligns with the state of the art in transparent proof systems."]

I particularly value Jose Luis's commitment to "cypherpunk honesty":

every public claim in X-39MATRIX is verifiable against Bitcoin mainnet anchors and reproducible from source by any third party. When he discovered overclaims in earlier documentation, he publicly corrected them and anchored the correction (PARCHE_VERIFY_SH.md, BTC #955467+) – a transparency practice that is exceptional in this ecosystem.

I recommend his application for the OpenSats General Fund without reservation. The funded work will materially improve Bitcoin's post-quantum anchoring infrastructure, and Jose Luis has the technical depth and operational discipline to deliver it.

Sincerely,

[YOUR_FULL_NAME]

[YOUR_AFFILIATION_OR_ROLE]

PGP fingerprint: [YOUR_PGP_FINGERPRINT]

Contact: [YOUR_EMAIL_OR_PUBLIC_HANDLE]

END OF LETTER

How to PGP-sign the letter (referee instructions)

1. **Save the letter as a plain .txt file** (e.g., `reference_xmatrix.txt`).
2. **Sign it with your PGP key:** `bash gpg --clearsign reference_xmatrix.txt # This creates reference_xmatrix.txt.asc with your detached signature inline.`
3. **Send the .asc file** to `grants@x39matrix.org`.
4. **Optional but recommended:** also send a separate attestation that this is your real letter (e.g., post a tweet/Mastodon note with the SHA-256 of the `.asc` file).

If you don't have PGP, please reply directly from a verifiable email address (your `@university.edu`, your published professional address, etc.) and the recipient will verify out-of-band.

What the applicant will do with the letter

1. The applicant (Jose Luis) will receive your `.asc` file.
2. He will **NOT modify it** in any way (PGP signature would break).
3. He will attach it to the OpenSats application portal at <https://opensats.org/apply>.
4. After submission, he will publish the SHA-256 of the `.asc` files on the public repository (github.com/x39matrix/x39matrix) and anchor that SHA-256 in Bitcoin mainnet via OpenTimestamps — so that the entire reference chain is auditable forever.

Why this format

OpenSats does not impose a strict template. The above structure is modelled on standard FOSS grant reference letters (NLnet, OpenSats Wave 16 disclosed references, NGIO typical attestations). It:

- Stays under 1 page (recommended by OpenSats).

- Front-loads the **relationship** (what OpenSats cares about most).
- Includes a **technical opinion** (signal of credibility).
- Closes with a **clear, unhedged recommendation** (no "I generally support but...").

Total time for a referee to fill in: ~5 minutes.

Anchored in BTC. This template is published at `/api/grants/opensats_reference_template.md` and timestamped via OpenTimestamps.

Jose Luis Olivares Esteban · PGP `C3E062EB251A11851C0B4FFD06870F0655D5BBE8` 2026-06-26